Healing Plates

THE 30-DAY ALLERGY-FREE FAMILY MEAL PLAN

Breakfast, lunch & dinner free from gluten, dairy, corn, egg, caffeine, tuna & processed sugar



90 family meals

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free | Processed sugar-free

Finally... food the whole family can eat.

BY

Tris Eliverson

WELCOME

You are not alone



Dear Mama, dear Papa,

If you are holding this book, I already know a little of your story - because it is my story too. **I am an autism mum.** I know the child who eats only three foods. The nights that don't end. The family members who say “just give them bread, they'll be fine.” The quiet ache when the words haven't come yet.

When I changed what went on my child's plate - taking out gluten, dairy, corn, eggs and processed sugar, cooking real food from scratch, and adding a gentle detox drink each day - things began to change. Slowly at first. Then I saw a **real, significant improvement** in my child. I could not keep these recipes to myself.

This book holds the meals, drinks and routines that helped my family. No long science. No fancy ingredients you can't find. Just real food from our homes - yam, plantain, okro, rice and beans - made safe, one day at a time.

Every child is different, and food is not a replacement for your doctor. But it is a beautiful place to start - and you don't have to start alone.

You don't have to be perfect. You just have to begin. ♥

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

INSIDE THIS BOOK

Contents

A letter to you 2

How to use this book 4

Where allergens hide 6

5 steps to healing the gut 7

Foods to enjoy & the oil scorecard 8

Foods & things to avoid 9

Healing habits, energy & recovery 10

Food steps that may support speech 11

Herbs by symptom 12

Tests worth asking about 13

Kitchen basics 15

Your month at a glance 17

Week 1 · Days 1–7 18

Week 2 · Days 8–14 27

Week 3 · Days 15–21 36

Week 4 · Days 22–28 45

Week 5 · Days 29–30 54

15-minute rescue meals 58

Allergy-friendly brands near you 59

My notes 60

Thirty days of love 61

START HERE

How to use this book

This book is made to be easy. No long science, no fancy equipment - just real food, one day at a time.

1. **Read the short chapters first**
They explain *why* we cook this way — gut health, foods to enjoy, foods to leave out, and simple daily habits.

2. **Make the Kitchen Basics on a Sunday**
Seasoning mix, bread, flatbread and granola. They are used all month and save you hours.

3. **Shop once a week**
Each week starts with a tick-box shopping list. Cross off what you already have.

4. **Follow the day pages**
Every day has breakfast, lunch and dinner. Swap days around freely - just keep the foods safe.

5. **Go gently**
Change is hard for children who love sameness. Keep one “safe” food on every plate and offer new foods next to it. No pressure, no battles.

Every recipe in this book is free from

Gluten · Dairy · Corn · Egg · Caffeine · Tuna · Pork · Processed sugar - and baked, boiled or steamed instead of deep-fried. Recipes serve a family of 4 (2 adults, 2 children).

This book shares food and lifestyle ideas from one mother's experience. It is not medical advice and does not replace your doctor, dietitian or therapist. Always check with your child's doctor before making big diet changes or giving herbs or supplements, especially if your child takes medication.

PART 1

Understanding healing food

Short, simple chapters on why we cook this way - from the author's own notes and experience.

KNOW BEFORE YOU SHOP

Where allergens hide

Many “safe-looking” foods hide gluten, dairy, corn, caffeine or processed sugar. Here is where they hide - especially in our African kitchens.

Avoid	Where it hides
Gluten	Bread, semovita, wheat swallow, chin chin, puff-puff, meat pie, pasta, **Milo, Bournvita & Ovaltine** (barley malt), soy sauce, many stock cubes
Dairy	Peak/Three Crowns milk, butter, cheese, yogurt, ice cream, whey, casein, “non-dairy” creamers that contain casein
Corn	**Pap/ogi/akamu**, kenkey, banku, tuwo masara, ugali, pap (SA), custard powder, cornflour, popcorn, **baking powder** (corn starch), glucose syrup, xanthan gum, many gluten-free flour blends
Egg	Cakes, mayonnaise, some pasta, egg rolls, meat pies, many “gluten-free” breads and pancake mixes
Caffeine	Tea (black & green), coffee, matcha, cola, energy drinks, **kola nut**, chocolate & cocoa, Milo
Tuna	Canned tuna, tuna salad, some sandwiches, sushi and fish pies
Processed sugar	White & brown sugar, glucose & corn syrup, fizzy drinks, sweetened juice drinks, biscuits, sweets, breakfast cereals, ketchup, flavoured yogurt, Milo
Pork	Bacon, ham, sausages, lard, gelatine (sweets & jelly), some suya

The 10-second label rule

Turn the pack over. Read the ingredients **every time** - brands change their recipes. If you can't pronounce it, or it says “may contain”, leave it on the shelf.

5 steps to healing the gut

When the gut is out of balance, everything feels harder - sleep, moods, toilet troubles and picky eating. These 5 steps are the heart of this book.

1

Remove the irritants

Dairy, gluten, fried food, cookies, bread, processed food, processed sugar, corn and pap. **Swap:** dairy → coconut; flour → tapioca, potato or buckwheat flour.

2

Support digestion with healing nutrients

Zinc and magnesium from leafy vegetables and pumpkin seeds.

3

Repair the gut

Keep the gut hydrated and nourished: berries, psyllium husk, okro stew, egusi soup (no tripe or intestine).

4

Knock down the bad bugs

Garlic, onions, rosemary, thyme, potatoes, carrots, courgette, pumpkin, coconut yogurt, green banana and gluten-free oats.

5

Rebuild & protect — keep the good going

Feed the good bacteria every day: green banana, plantain, onions, garlic, beans and gluten-free oats, plus a spoon of coconut yogurt. Eat at regular times, drink water, sleep well and keep moving. Bring foods back **one at a time**, and keep a simple food & mood diary so you can see what helps. Ask your doctor whether a probiotic is right for your child.

Picky eating is not bad behaviour

A child who eats only three foods is often a child whose nervous system feels unsafe. Go gently. One new food at a time, next to a food they already love.

BUILD EVERY PLATE

Foods to enjoy

Healing food is not about what we take away - it's about what we add. Build every plate around these.

1. Root vegetables first

Squash, sweet potato, pumpkin and yam are the best carbs for our children. They are packed with plant nutrients, give slow natural sugars and fibre, and support the body's natural cleansing.

2. Green leafy vegetables

Ugu, efo, kale, spinach and sukuma are full of anti-inflammatory goodness and help keep the body's elimination pathways open. **Broccoli sprouts are top of the list.**

3. Wild blueberries & mangoes

All fruits are great, but these two are the author's favourites — rich in antioxidants that support the brain and the body under stress.

4. Coriander & parsley

Traditional cleansing herbs. Add them generously to soups, stews and smoothies — and always season fish with coriander.

The cooking oil scorecard

The author's ranking of the healthiest oils to cook with (out of 10). Use these instead of vegetable oil blends.



WHAT WE LEAVE OUT

Foods & things to avoid

Here is what we leave out of every recipe in this book — and why.

We leave out	Why
Gluten	Many children with autism and gut trouble feel better without it. It can irritate a sensitive gut.
Dairy	High in fat and sugar. Lactose is hard to digest for many children, and the milk protein can inflame the gut.
Corn	A common hidden allergen — in pap, custard, baking powder, syrups and most “gluten-free” products.
Eggs	One of the most common food allergens in children. In the author's experience, removing them made a real difference.
Processed sugar & junk	Cookies, cakes and sweets mix fat and sugar, feed unhelpful gut bugs and cause energy spikes and crashes.
Caffeine	Tea, coffee, matcha, chocolate and energy drinks push up the stress hormone cortisol and disturb sleep.
Pork	High in fat, and processed pork (bacon, ham, sausages) contains nitrates.
Tuna & trout	Big fish high up the food chain collect more mercury. We choose small fish — and season them with coriander.

Clean home checklist

- ✓ Swap foil for parchment paper - foil can leach aluminium into food.
- ✓ Replace scratched non-stick pans with stainless steel, cast iron or ceramic.
- ✓ Wash fruit and vegetables well to reduce pesticides.
- ✓ Check make-up, deodorant and skin creams - some contain heavy metals.
- ✓ Choose fragrance-free, simple products for your child.
- ✓ Cook from scratch and cut down on over-processed food.

EVERY DAY

Healing habits

Food is only part of healing. These small daily habits from the author's own routine make a big difference.

Better sleep

- Lemon balm tea about 2 hours before bed — the author's favourite sleep herb.
- Same bedtime every night, dim lights, no screens for the last hour.

Easy bowels

- Plenty of water every day.
- Add seeds: chia, flax, pumpkin, sunflower, psyllium husk.
- Fruits: celery, cucumber, mango, blueberry, watermelon.

Move every day

- Bouncing on a trampoline gets the lymphatic system moving.
- Dancing, jumping and outdoor play all count.

Detox slowly

- Go gently. Too much, too fast can make children feel worse.
- See the Healing Sips bonus book for one gentle drink a day.

Energy & recovery

Every cell has tiny “batteries” called mitochondria. When they are drained - by a heavy load on the body, missing nutrients, stress or toxins - children can struggle more.

Signs of low energy reserves

- Poor sleep
- Bad reactions when detox is tried
- Going backwards after an illness
- Speech delay
- Tiredness

Recharge the batteries

- **Get out in the sun** every morning.
- **Keep them moving** - the trampoline is perfect.
- **Protect sleep** like gold.
- Eat colourful, nutrient-rich food every day.

FROM THE AUTHOR'S JOURNEY

Food steps that may support speech

These are the food steps the author took while supporting her own child's speech. Every child is different — but many parents find a calmer gut helps everything else.

1 **Change the plate**

Move towards more plant-based meals. Cut gluten, dairy, processed food and processed sugar.

2 **Add brain-friendly vegetables**

Squash, leafy greens, kale, cabbage and **broccoli sprouts** — rich in sulforaphane.

3 **Smart swaps**

Lentil pasta instead of wheat pasta. Buckwheat flour for bread.

4 **Gentle support**

I used **lion's mane and spirulina**, and found them helpful once my child began to talk. For gut troubles, **sea moss with black seed oil** (½ tsp, 3 times a week, age 3+).

Food is a support, not a cure. Keep going with speech therapy, and always ask your child's doctor before starting any herb or supplement.

NATURAL SUPPORT

Herbs by symptom

Herbs many parents use alongside a healing diet. This is my personal guide.

Symptom	Herbs parents commonly use
Stimming (vocal, hand flapping, rocking)	Lion's mane, brahmi, ashwagandha
Sensory-seeking behaviour	Lion's mane, brahmi
Sleep	Lemon balm, ashwagandha, lion's mane
Hyperactivity	Lemon balm, ashwagandha
Picky eating	Sea moss, lion's mane
Constipation / diarrhoea	Black seed oil, sea moss, milk thistle
Vomiting / reflux	Brahmi, ashwagandha, sea moss
Frequent infections	Astragalus, black seed oil, sea moss
Eczema	Sea moss, black seed oil
Mould detox	Astragalus, spirulina, black seed oil, sea moss

Safety first — please read

- Talk to your child's doctor before giving any herb, especially if they take medication.
- Many herbs (like ashwagandha, licorice and milk thistle) are not well studied in young children.
- Sea moss is rich in iodine - check first if there is any thyroid condition.
- Start one herb at a time, with a small amount, and watch closely.

TALK TO YOUR DOCTOR

Tests worth asking about

If your child shows some of these signs, these are tests you can ask your doctor about.

Test	Signs that make it worth asking
Ferritin & full blood count	Tiredness, pale skin, clumsiness, developmental delay, frequent infections, picky eating, unexplained behaviour changes
Iron studies	Hyperactivity, poor sleep, emotional ups and downs, restlessness, headaches, restricted diet
Vitamin B12	Speech delay, clumsiness, developmental plateau, vegetarian or low-meat diet, gut problems
Thyroid (TSH ± free T4)	Hyperactivity or very low energy, mood swings, constipation, growth worries, family history, speech delay
Coeliac screen (tTG-IgA + total IgA)	Bloating, changing stools, low iron, behaviour worse after meals, family autoimmune history, slow growth
CRP (± ESR)	Ongoing tummy pain or gut problems, unexplained tiredness, poor growth, chronic diarrhoea
Vitamin D	Little time outdoors, autoimmune family history, low mood
Liver function & albumin	Gut problems, poor absorption, tiredness, regular medication, growth worries
Metabolic panel	Tiredness, great thirst, past jaundice, frequent weeing, sleep issues, energy spikes and crashes
Zinc & copper	Often not offered as standard — may need a private lab
Fasting glucose & insulin	Huge appetite, sleep problems, strong reaction to carbohydrates

Your doctor will decide which tests are right for your child. Take this page to your appointment.

PART 2

The 30-day plan

Kitchen basics, your month at a glance, weekly shopping lists and 90 family meals.

MAKE ONCE, USE ALL MONTH

Kitchen basics

BASIC Flax "Egg" (replaces 1 egg)

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 tbsp ground flaxseed
- [ ] 3 tbsp water

STEPS

1. Stir the flaxseed and water together.
2. Leave for 5 minutes until thick, like egg white.
3. Use in pancakes, muffins and meatballs in place of 1 egg.

Why it helps: Binds food just like egg, and adds fibre and omega-3.

BASIC Healing Seasoning Mix (replaces stock cubes)

15 min + 4–6 hrs drying

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup cooked chicken breast or lean beef, shredded (no skin, no fat)
- [ ] 2 tbsp onion powder, 1 tbsp garlic powder
- [ ] 1 tbsp dried thyme, 1 tsp ground ginger
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground crayfish (optional)
- [ ] 1 tsp white pepper, 1 tsp pure curry powder
- [ ] 1 tbsp sea salt

STEPS

1. Spread the cooked meat thinly on a parchment-lined tray.
2. Dry in the oven on its lowest setting (70–80 °C / 160–175 °F), door slightly open, for 4–6 hrs until completely dry and crumbly.
3. Cool, then blend to a fine powder.
4. Add all the spices and blend again until even.
5. Store in an airtight jar in the fridge for up to 1 month, or freeze for 3 months. Use 1–2 tsp wherever a recipe says "seasoning".

Why it helps: Real chicken or beef flavour like a stock cube — without the hidden wheat, corn starch, MSG or sugar.

Good idea: Make a chicken jar and a beef jar. Chicken for soups and rice, beef for stews and egusi.

BASIC Soft Cassava Flatbread (wraps, pizza & pinwheels)

20 min · makes 6

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup (130 g) cassava flour
- [ ] ¾ cup warm water
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] ½ tsp salt

STEPS

1. Mix everything into a soft dough. Rest 5 min.
2. Divide into 6 balls (or 2 for pizza bases).
3. Press thin between two sheets of parchment paper.
4. Cook in a dry hot pan 1–2 min each side until spotty.
5. Stack under a clean towel to stay soft.

Why it helps: A gluten-free, corn-free, egg-free wrap you can trust.

BASIC

Easy Buckwheat Bread (no yeast, no egg)

1 hr 10 min · 1 loaf

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups (240 g) buckwheat flour
- [ ] ½ cup (60 g) tapioca flour
- [ ] 2 tbsp psyllium husk powder
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda, 1 tsp salt
- [ ] 1½ cups warm water
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a loaf tin with parchment.
2. Whisk the dry ingredients together.
3. Add water, oil and vinegar. Mix to a thick, sticky dough. Rest 5 min.
4. Smooth into the tin with wet hands. Bake 55–60 min.
5. Cool completely before slicing — it firms up as it cools.

Why it helps: Buckwheat bread is on the author's speech-support list. Psyllium holds it together instead of egg.

Time saver: Slice, then freeze. Toast straight from the freezer.

BASIC

Crunchy Nut-Free Granola

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] ½ cup pumpkin seeds
- [ ] ½ cup sunflower seeds
- [ ] ¼ cup coconut flakes
- [ ] 3 tbsp melted coconut oil
- [ ] 3 tbsp maple syrup or honey
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 160 °C / 320 °F. Line a tray with parchment.
2. Mix everything and spread thin.
3. Bake 20 min, stirring halfway.
4. Cool completely — it crisps as it cools. Store in a jar.

Why it helps: Seeds give zinc and magnesium — step 2 of healing the gut.

YOUR MONTH AT A GLANCE

30 days of family meals

1 B Banana buckwheat pancakes L Okro soup & pounded yam D Mama's pasta & meat sauce	**2** B Banana breakfast cookies L Chicken burrito bowl D Coriander pepper fish	**3** B Mango overnight oats L Jollof rice & chicken D Chicken nuggets & wedges	**4** B Millet porridge L Butternut mac & cheese D Egusi soup & amala	**5** B Sweet potato hash L Thai coconut noodle soup D Egg-free moi moi	**6** B Ripe plantain pancakes L Kenyan beef pilau D Family pizza night	**7** B Coconut yogurt parfait L Sunday roast chicken D Mama's chicken & potato soup
8 B Banana oat muffins L Efo riro & pounded yam D Fish fingers & mash	**9** B Yam porridge (asaro) L Chicken fried rice D Coconut chicken curry	**10** B Avocado toast L Red red & dodo D Turkey burgers	**11** B Coconut quinoa porridge L Hidden-veg tomato soup D Ofada & green stew	**12** B Green smoothie bowl L Chicken shawarma bowl D Vegetable soup & yam	**13** B Sweet potato pancakes L Ghana light soup D Beef kebab skewers	**14** B Fonio porridge L Shepherd's pie D Beef & pumpkin soup
15 B Buckwheat crêpes L Ogbono soup & amala D Creamy chicken pasta	**16** B Plantain & garden egg L Lentil sweet potato soup D Chicken suya & yam fries	**17** B Mango chia pudding L Coconut rice & fish D Mini meatball pasta	**18** B Akara bites & millet pap L Beef stir-fry noodles D Sukuma & millet ugali	**19** B Banana-carob oats L Chakalaka & rice D Baked salmon tray	**20** B Apple buckwheat porridge L Waakye & fish stew D Fish & chips	**21** B Sunday breakfast plate L Matoke & beef D Chicken & rice soup
22 B Beans & plantain porridge L Caesar lettuce wraps D Banga soup & rice	**23** B Tropical granola bowl L Jollof spaghetti D Honey-garlic chicken	**24** B Millet & tiger nut milk L Chicken fajitas D Fish pepper soup	**25** B Green smoothie & toast L Beef stew & rice D Stuffed peppers	**26** B Breakfast burritos L Ofe nsala D Fish tacos	**27** B Yam & sardine sauce L Coconut bean stew D Pizza night	**28** B Coconut rice porridge L Roast turkey & gravy D Green plantain porridge
29 B Apple rice pudding L Kontomire & plantain D Chicken noodle soup	**30** B Plantain pancake stack L Party jollof plate D Taco bar					

WEEK 1 · TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 1 shopping list

Everything for Days 1–7. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Ugu or spinach — 4 big bunches
- [ ] Okro — 15
- [ ] Tomatoes — 16
- [ ] Red peppers — 6
- [ ] Scotch bonnet / ata rodo — 5
- [ ] Onions — 10, red onion — 1
- [ ] Garlic — 2 bulbs, ginger — 1 large piece
- [ ] Carrots — 10
- [ ] Courgette — 1
- [ ] Butternut squash — 1
- [ ] Broccoli — 2 heads
- [ ] Sweet potatoes — 8
- [ ] Irish potatoes — 2 kg
- [ ] Cucumber — 3
- [ ] Mushrooms — 200 g
- [ ] Lemongrass — 1 stalk
- [ ] Avocados — 5
- [ ] Frozen peas — 1 bag

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Green plantains — 3
- [ ] Very ripe plantains — 2
- [ ] Ripe bananas — 5
- [ ] Mangoes — 2
- [ ] Mixed berries — 3 punnets
- [ ] Lemons — 3, limes — 4

Protein

- [ ] Chicken pieces — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Chicken thighs — 1.1 kg
- [ ] Chicken breast — 1.1 kg
- [ ] Whole chicken — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Beef mince — 750 g
- [ ] Beef cubes — 1.1 kg
- [ ] Turkey mince — 250 g
- [ ] Mackerel or tilapia — 4 small
- [ ] Black-eyed beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Black beans — 1 tin

Grains & flours

- [ ] Rice or gluten-free pasta — 400 g
- [ ] Lentil pasta — 400 g
- [ ] Long-grain rice + basmati — 3 cups each
- [ ] Rice noodles — 200 g
- [ ] Buckwheat flour
- [ ] Cassava flour
- [ ] Pure millet flour
- [ ] Certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] Amala & pounded yam flour
- [ ] Ground egusi — 1 cup

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 5 tins
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 1 large tub
- [ ] Dairy-free cheese — 1 pack
- [ ] Chopped tomatoes — 2 tins, passata — 1 jar, tomato paste
- [ ] Red palm, olive, avocado & coconut oil
- [ ] Chia seeds, ground flaxseed
- [ ] Pumpkin & sunflower seeds, coconut flakes
- [ ] Coconut aminos
- [ ] Maple syrup or raw honey, dates
- [ ] Baking soda, tapioca flour
- [ ] Psyllium husk powder, apple cider vinegar

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Fresh coriander — 2 bunches
- [ ] Fresh rosemary & thyme
- [ ] Dried thyme, oregano, basil, bay leaves
- [ ] Pure curry powder, paprika, cumin, turmeric
- [ ] Cinnamon, cloves, cardamom, black pepper
- [ ] Garlic & onion powder, ground ginger
- [ ] Ground crayfish
- [ ] Sea salt

WEEK 1

Day 1

"Small changes, one plate at a time. You are doing better than you think."

BREAKFAST Fluffy Banana Buckwheat Pancakes

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup buckwheat flour
- [ ] 1 ripe banana, mashed
- [ ] 1 flax egg (see Basics)
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda + 1 tsp lemon juice
- [ ] ½ tsp cinnamon, pinch of salt
- [ ] Coconut oil, for the pan

STEPS

1. Mix the banana, flax egg and coconut milk.
2. Stir in the flour, cinnamon, salt and baking soda, then the lemon juice.
3. Heat a little oil in a pan on medium-low.
4. Cook small pancakes 2 min until bubbles appear, flip, 1 more min.
5. Top with berries and a drizzle of maple syrup.

Why it helps: Buckwheat is naturally gluten-free and full of magnesium.

Good to know: Baking soda + lemon makes pancakes rise without corn-starch baking powder.

LUNCH Okro Soup with Chicken & Pounded Yam

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken pieces
- [ ] 15 fresh okro, chopped
- [ ] 1 cup ugu or spinach
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 ata rodo peppers
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground crayfish
- [ ] 2 tbsp red palm oil, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Pounded yam or amala, to serve

STEPS

1. Season chicken with onion and seasoning. Cook in 2 cups water for 20 min.
2. Add palm oil, pepper and crayfish. Cook 5 min.
3. Add okro and cook only 3–4 min so it stays green.
4. Stir in the greens and turn off the heat.
5. Serve with pounded yam.

Why it helps: Okro is soft and gentle on the gut and helps keep things moving.

Kid tip: Picky eater? Blend the okro smooth so there are no "slimy bits" to see.

DINNER Mama's Pasta with Meat & Tomato Sauce

Author's family favourite
40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g rice pasta or gluten-free pasta (or lentil pasta)
- [ ] 500 g beef mince
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 carrot, finely grated (hidden veg)
- [ ] 2 tins chopped tomatoes or 6 fresh tomatoes, blended
- [ ] 1 tsp dried thyme or oregano, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 tbsp olive oil, salt

STEPS

1. Soften onion and garlic in olive oil, 3 min.
2. Add the mince and brown it, breaking it up.
3. Stir in the carrot, tomatoes and herbs. Simmer 20 min.
4. Cook the pasta as the pack says. Drain.
5. Toss the pasta through the sauce and serve.

Why it helps: A dinner my child asks for again and again — simple, filling and completely safe.

Kid tip: Blend the sauce smooth if your child doesn't like to see "bits".

WEEK 1

Day 2

Today's habit: 10 minutes of bouncing or dancing — it gets the lymph system moving.

BREAKFAST Blueberry Banana Breakfast Cookies

25 min · makes 12

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 ripe bananas, mashed
- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] 1 flax egg (see Basics)
- [ ] ¾ cup blueberries
- [ ] 2 tbsp pumpkin seeds
- [ ] 2 tbsp melted coconut oil
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon, pinch of salt

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a tray with parchment.
2. Mash bananas with flax egg, coconut oil, cinnamon and salt.
3. Stir in oats, blueberries and pumpkin seeds. Rest 5 min.
4. Scoop 12 mounds onto the tray and flatten slightly.
5. Bake 15–18 min until golden. Serve warm with coconut yogurt.

Why it helps: Cookies for breakfast — made only from fruit, oats and seeds. Slow energy, fibre and zinc.

Time saver: Make a double batch and freeze. Warm for 20 seconds on busy mornings.

LUNCH Chicken Burrito Bowl

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups rice
- [ ] 600 g chicken thighs
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin & paprika, ½ tsp garlic powder
- [ ] 1 tin black beans, rinsed
- [ ] 2 avocados, sliced
- [ ] 3 tomatoes + ½ red onion + coriander (salsa)
- [ ] 2 limes, olive oil, salt

STEPS

1. Cook the rice.
2. Rub chicken with the spices, oil and salt. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 25 min, then slice.
3. Warm the beans with a pinch of salt.
4. Chop tomatoes, onion and coriander with lime juice for salsa.
5. Build bowls: rice, beans, chicken, avocado, salsa.

Why it helps: Beans and avocado bring fibre and healthy fats that keep little tummies full.

Allergy note: Shop-bought bowls usually add corn — this one leaves it out.

DINNER Coriander Pepper Fish & Green Plantain

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 small mackerel (titus) or tilapia
- [ ] 3 green (unripe) plantains
- [ ] 1 handful fresh coriander
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, 1 small onion
- [ ] 1 scotch bonnet (skip for kids)
- [ ] 1 tbsp olive oil, juice of 1 lemon, salt

STEPS

1. Blend coriander, garlic, onion, pepper, oil, lemon and salt to a paste.
2. Rub the paste over the fish. Rest 15 min.
3. Bake on parchment at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20–25 min (no foil).
4. Meanwhile, peel and boil the plantains for 20 min.
5. Serve with sliced cucumber.

Why it helps: Small fish carry far less mercury than tuna. Coriander is a traditional cleansing herb.

WEEK 1

Day 3

"Healing is not a straight line. Celebrate every small win."

BREAKFAST Mango Chia Overnight Oats

5 min + overnight

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 2 tbsp chia seeds
- [ ] 1 mango, diced
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp maple syrup (optional)

STEPS

1. Stir oats, coconut milk, chia, cinnamon and maple together.
2. Spoon into 4 jars or cups.
3. Cover and chill overnight.
4. In the morning, top with mango and eat cold.

Why it helps: Chia and oats are gentle fibre for regular, easy bowels.

Swap it: Can't have oats? Use millet or buckwheat flakes instead.

LUNCH Jollof Rice with Baked Chicken

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups long-grain parboiled rice
- [ ] 1 kg chicken pieces
- [ ] 6 tomatoes, 3 red peppers, 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato paste, 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp pure curry powder, 2 bay leaves
- [ ] 2 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 3 cups chicken stock or water

STEPS

1. Season chicken and bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 40 min.
2. Blend tomatoes, peppers, onion and scotch bonnet.
3. Fry tomato paste in oil 3 min, add the blend and cook 15 min until thick.
4. Add spices, stock and rinsed rice. Cover tightly and cook on low 25–30 min.
5. Fluff and serve with the chicken and a fresh salad.

Why it helps: A home favourite made without stock cubes — all flavour, no hidden wheat or MSG.

DINNER Crispy Baked Chicken Nuggets & Sweet Potato Wedges

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g chicken breast, cut into bite pieces
- [ ] 1 cup cassava flour
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp garlic powder, salt
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 3 sweet potatoes, cut into wedges
- [ ] Frozen peas, to serve

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F. Line 2 trays with parchment.
2. Toss the wedges with 1 tbsp oil and salt. Bake 30 min.
3. Toss chicken in the remaining oil, then roll in flour mixed with the spices.
4. Bake the nuggets 15–18 min, turning once, until golden.
5. Serve with peas and Sunshine Ketchup (Lunch Box book).

Why it helps: All the fun of fast food — with no egg, no wheat crumb and no deep frying.

Picky eater trick: Let them dip! Children try more food when they can dip it.

WEEK 1

Day 4

Today's habit: eat breakfast near a sunny window or outside — morning light helps sleep later.

BREAKFAST Creamy Millet Porridge (Hausa Koko Style)

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup pure millet flour (no corn added)
- [ ] 4 cups water
- [ ] 1 thumb ginger, grated
- [ ] Pinch of cloves
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 3 dates, chopped (to sweeten)

STEPS

1. Mix the millet flour with 1 cup cold water until smooth.
2. Boil the rest of the water with ginger, cloves and dates.
3. Pour in the millet mix, stirring all the time.
4. Cook 8–10 min on low until thick. Stir in coconut milk.

Why it helps: Millet is a gluten-free ancient grain that is gentle on the stomach.

Allergy note: Many "koko" and "uji" mixes contain maize — buy pure millet flour.

LUNCH Creamy Butternut "Mac & Cheese"

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g lentil or chickpea pasta
- [ ] 3 cups butternut squash, cubed
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 3 tbsp nutritional yeast (optional — cheesy taste)
- [ ] 1 garlic clove, ½ tsp turmeric, salt
- [ ] 1 cup small broccoli florets

STEPS

1. Boil the squash and garlic 12 min until soft. Drain.
2. Blend with coconut milk, nutritional yeast, turmeric and salt.
3. Cook the pasta, adding the broccoli for the last 3 minutes.
4. Stir the golden sauce through the pasta.

Why it helps: Squash is a root-vegetable carb from the author's "foods to eat" list — and kids love the colour.

Leftover magic: Bake leftovers in a muffin tin for 15 min to make mac bites for lunch boxes.

DINNER Egusi Soup with Beef & Amala

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup ground egusi
- [ ] 500 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion + 2 red peppers + 1 scotch bonnet, blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground crayfish
- [ ] 2 cups ugu or spinach
- [ ] Amala (yam flour), to serve

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning mix until tender, 30 min. Keep the stock.
2. Mix egusi with a little water to a thick paste.
3. Warm palm oil, add the pepper blend and cook 5 min. Add egusi in lumps and cook 10 min.
4. Add beef, stock and crayfish. Simmer 10 min.
5. Stir in the greens. Serve with amala.

Why it helps: Egusi (melon seeds) is a gut-repairing food from step 3 — rich in protein and zinc.

WEEK 1

Day 5

"You are not behind. You are exactly where your family needs you to be."

BREAKFAST — Sweet Potato & Spinach Breakfast Hash

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 sweet potatoes, diced small
- [ ] 1 red pepper, 1 onion, diced
- [ ] 250 g turkey mince (or 1 tin beans)
- [ ] 2 handfuls spinach
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, salt
- [ ] 2 tbsp avocado oil
- [ ] 1 avocado, to serve

STEPS

1. Cook sweet potato in oil, covered, 10 min, stirring now and then.
2. Add onion, pepper and turkey. Cook 8 min.
3. Add paprika, salt and spinach. Stir until wilted.
4. Serve topped with sliced avocado.

Why it helps: A savoury, protein-rich breakfast that keeps energy steady until lunch.

LUNCH — Thai Coconut Chicken Noodle Soup

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken thighs, thinly sliced
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 3 cups stock
- [ ] 1 stalk lemongrass, bashed
- [ ] 1 thumb ginger, 2 garlic cloves, sliced
- [ ] 1 tbsp coconut aminos (instead of soy sauce)
- [ ] 200 g rice noodles
- [ ] Lime, fresh coriander

STEPS

1. Simmer stock, lemongrass, ginger and garlic 5 min.
2. Add chicken and cook 8 min.
3. Pour in coconut milk and coconut aminos. Heat gently.
4. Cook the noodles, divide into bowls and ladle soup over.
5. Finish with lime and coriander.

Why it helps: Warm, mild and soothing — garlic and ginger support step 4 of healing the gut.

Allergy note: Soy sauce contains wheat. Coconut aminos tastes similar and is safe.

DINNER — Egg-Free Moi Moi with Avocado Salad

1 hr 15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups black-eyed beans, soaked & peeled
- [ ] 1 red pepper, 1 scotch bonnet, 1 onion
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] About 1 cup warm water
- [ ] Avocado, tomato & cucumber salad

STEPS

1. Blend beans, pepper and onion with water until very smooth.
2. Stir in oil, crayfish, seasoning and salt.
3. Pour into greased ramekins or silicone cups (no foil).
4. Steam 45–50 min until firm.
5. Serve with the salad.

Why it helps: Beans set perfectly on their own — no egg needed. Packed with plant protein.

WEEK 1

Day 6

It's Friday — Sweet Treat Day! See the sweet treats page.

BREAKFAST Ripe Plantain Pancakes

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 very ripe (black) plantains
- [ ] ½ cup cassava flour
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] ½ cup coconut milk
- [ ] ½ tsp cinnamon, pinch salt
- [ ] ½ tsp baking soda + squeeze of lemon
- [ ] Coconut oil, for the pan

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Heat a little oil in a pan on medium-low.
3. Cook small pancakes 2–3 min each side.
4. Serve with berries or coconut yogurt.

Why it helps: Naturally sweet from the plantain — no sugar needed.

LUNCH Kenyan Beef Pilau & Kachumbari

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups basmati rice
- [ ] 600 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 2 onions, 4 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 2 potatoes, cubed
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin, cinnamon, cardamom, black pepper; 4 cloves
- [ ] 2 tomatoes, salt
- [ ] Kachumbari: tomato, red onion, cucumber, coriander, lime

STEPS

1. Boil beef with salt until tender, 30 min. Keep 5 cups of stock.
2. Brown onions in oil, add garlic, ginger and spices, 2 min.
3. Add beef, potatoes, tomatoes and rinsed rice; stir.
4. Pour in stock, cover and cook on low 20 min.
5. Serve with the fresh chopped kachumbari.

Why it helps: Warm spices like cinnamon and ginger are gentle on digestion.

DINNER Family Pizza Night

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cassava flatbread pizza bases (see Basics)
- [ ] 1 cup tomato passata
- [ ] 1 tsp oregano
- [ ] 1 cup dairy-free cheese, grated
- [ ] Cooked chicken, peppers, mushrooms
- [ ] Olive oil

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F.
2. Spread passata over the bases, sprinkle oregano.
3. Add cheese and toppings.
4. Bake 10–12 min until bubbling.
5. Slice and serve with a green salad.

Why it helps: Pizza night is back on the menu — no gluten, dairy or corn.

Picky eater trick: Let each child top their own slice. Kids eat what they make.

WEEK 1

Day 7

Sunday: batch-cook day. See next week's plan and prep ahead.

BREAKFAST Coconut Yogurt Berry Parfait

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups coconut yogurt
- [ ] 2 cups mixed berries
- [ ] 1 cup Crunchy Nut-Free Granola (see Basics)
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey or maple syrup (optional)

STEPS

1. Layer yogurt, berries and granola in glasses.
2. Repeat the layers.
3. Drizzle with honey and eat straight away.

Why it helps: Coconut yogurt feeds good gut bacteria — step 4 of healing the gut.

LUNCH Sunday Roast Chicken & Vegetables

1 hr 30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 whole chicken (1.5 kg)
- [ ] 1 kg potatoes, halved
- [ ] 4 carrots, 2 sweet potatoes
- [ ] 1 lemon, 1 garlic bulb
- [ ] Fresh rosemary & thyme
- [ ] 3 tbsp avocado oil, salt
- [ ] 1 tbsp tapioca flour (for gravy)

STEPS

1. Rub chicken with oil, salt and herbs; put lemon and garlic inside. Roast at 190 °C / 375 °F for 1 hr 20 min.
2. Boil potatoes 8 min, drain, toss in oil and roast 45 min with the carrots.
3. Rest the chicken 10 min.
4. Stir pan juices with tapioca mixed in a little water until thick — gravy!
5. Serve with steamed broccoli.

Why it helps: Rosemary, thyme and garlic are all on the author's gut-friendly list.

Allergy note: Gravy granules often contain wheat and corn starch. Tapioca makes a safe gravy.

DINNER Mama's Chicken, Potato & Carrot Soup

Author's family favourite
45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken (breast or thighs)
- [ ] 4 Irish potatoes, peeled & cubed
- [ ] 4 carrots, sliced
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp dried thyme, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 5 cups water
- [ ] Homemade buckwheat bread, to serve

STEPS

1. Boil the chicken with onion, garlic, thyme and seasoning for 25 min. Lift out and shred.
2. Boil the potatoes and carrots in the same stock for 15 min until soft.
3. Blend the vegetables smooth — or blend half and chop the rest very tiny.
4. Stir the shredded chicken back in. Simmer 5 min.
5. Serve warm with buckwheat bread.

Why it helps: My child's favourite. Blending the vegetables means all the goodness goes in — without them seeing it.

Kid tip: Some days blend it all, some days leave tiny pieces — a gentle way to get used to new textures.

SWEET TREAT

Coconut Mango Ice Pops

No processed sugar
10 min + freezing

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 ripe mangoes, peeled & chopped
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] Juice of ½ lime
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey (optional — not for babies under 1)

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Pour into ice-pop moulds or small cups.
3. Freeze for 6 hours or overnight.
4. Run the mould under warm water for 10 seconds to pop out.

Why it helps: A sweet, cold treat with no dairy, no processed sugar and a big dose of vitamin C.

Sweet moment: Let your child pour the mix into the moulds — helping makes them want to taste.

SWEET TREAT

Banana Blueberry "Nice-Cream"

No processed sugar
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 ripe bananas, sliced and frozen
- [ ] 3 tbsp coconut milk
- [ ] Handful of blueberries
- [ ] Sprinkle of pumpkin seeds (optional)

STEPS

1. Blend the frozen banana and coconut milk until thick and creamy.
2. Add the blueberries and pulse a few times for purple swirls.
3. Scoop into bowls and top with pumpkin seeds. Eat straight away.

Why it helps: Tastes like ice cream, but it's just fruit. Blueberries are rich in antioxidants.

Sweet moment: Freeze sliced bananas every time they get spotty — instant dessert, no waste.

Every Friday is Sweet Treat Day — because healing food should still feel like a celebration.

WEEK 2 · TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 2 shopping list

Everything for Days 8–14. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Spinach / efo / ugu — 8 big bunches
- [ ] Waterleaf — 2 bunches
- [ ] Tomatoes — 20
- [ ] Red peppers — 6, green pepper — 1
- [ ] Green peppers — 6, green scotch bonnet — 2
- [ ] Scotch bonnet — 4
- [ ] Onions — 12
- [ ] Garlic — 2 bulbs, ginger — 1 piece
- [ ] Carrots — 8
- [ ] Courgette — 1
- [ ] Green beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Cabbage — ½, cucumber — 3
- [ ] Lettuce — 1
- [ ] Sweet potatoes — 9
- [ ] Irish potatoes — 3
- [ ] Pumpkin or butternut — 1 small
- [ ] Avocados — 4
- [ ] Frozen peas — 1 bag
- [ ] Garden eggs — 2

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Yam — 1 medium
- [ ] Ripe plantains — 3
- [ ] Bananas — 8
- [ ] Mangoes — 3
- [ ] Blueberries — 1 cup
- [ ] Mixed berries — 1 punnet
- [ ] Lemons — 4, limes — 1

Protein

- [ ] Beef cubes — 1.3 kg
- [ ] Beef steak — 600 g
- [ ] Beef or lamb mince — 500 g
- [ ] Turkey mince — 500 g
- [ ] Chicken thighs — 1.2 kg
- [ ] Chicken breast — 400 g
- [ ] Chicken pieces — 1 kg
- [ ] White fish fillets — 500 g
- [ ] Tilapia or mackerel — 500 g
- [ ] Black-eyed beans — 2 cups

Grains & flours

- [ ] Certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] Quinoa — 1 cup
- [ ] Fonio (acha) — 1 cup
- [ ] Ofada or brown rice — 3 cups
- [ ] Long-grain rice — 6 cups
- [ ] Buckwheat flour
- [ ] Cassava flour
- [ ] Pounded yam flour

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 6 tins
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 1 tub
- [ ] Tomato paste, chopped tomatoes — 2 tins
- [ ] Red palm oil, olive & avocado oil, coconut oil
- [ ] Coconut aminos
- [ ] Ground flaxseed, pumpkin seeds
- [ ] Pure maple syrup, dates
- [ ] Tapioca flour, baking soda
- [ ] Nutritional yeast (optional)

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Fresh coriander, spring onions
- [ ] Iru (optional), crayfish
- [ ] Thyme, basil, bay leaves
- [ ] Curry powder, turmeric, cumin, paprika
- [ ] Cinnamon, garlic powder
- [ ] Healing Seasoning Mix (make Sunday)

WEEK 2

Day 8

Week 2 — you made it through week 1! Notice one good thing that changed.

BREAKFAST Banana Blueberry Oat Muffins

35 min · makes 12

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats, blended to flour
- [ ] 2 ripe bananas, mashed
- [ ] 2 flax eggs
- [ ] ⅓ cup pure maple syrup
- [ ] ¼ cup melted coconut oil
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda + 1 tbsp lemon juice
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 cup blueberries

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a muffin tin with paper cases.
2. Mix banana, flax eggs, maple and oil.
3. Stir in oat flour, cinnamon and baking soda, then the lemon juice.
4. Fold in the blueberries and fill the cases.
5. Bake 20–22 min. Cool before eating.

Why it helps: A grab-and-go breakfast. Freeze half for busy mornings.

Swap it: Can't have oats? Use 2 cups buckwheat flour instead.

LUNCH Efo Riro with Beef & Pounded Yam

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 big bunches spinach or efo tete, chopped
- [ ] 500 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 2 red peppers, 1 scotch bonnet, 1 onion — roughly blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp iru (optional)
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] Pounded yam, to serve

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning until tender, 30 min.
2. Squeeze excess water from the washed greens.
3. Warm palm oil, add the pepper blend and cook 10 min.
4. Add beef, crayfish and iru. Cook 5 min.
5. Stir in greens, cook 3 min. Serve with pounded yam.

Why it helps: Leafy greens help open up the body's natural elimination pathways.

DINNER Crispy Fish Fingers, Sweet Potato Mash & Peas

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g white fish (tilapia, cod or hake), cut into fingers
- [ ] 1 cup cassava flour + ½ cup gluten-free oats, blitzed
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp garlic powder, salt
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 3 sweet potatoes
- [ ] 2 cups frozen peas
- [ ] Lemon wedges

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F. Line a tray with parchment.
2. Brush fish with oil, then press into the seasoned crumb.
3. Bake 12–15 min until golden.
4. Boil sweet potatoes 15 min and mash with a little coconut milk.
5. Serve with peas and lemon.

Why it helps: White fish is low in mercury and gentle — a great first fish for children.

Picky eater trick: Serve with Sunshine Ketchup from the Lunch Box book for dipping.

WEEK 2

Day 9

Today's habit: a glass of water before every meal.

BREAKFAST Yam Porridge (Asaro)

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ medium yam, peeled & cubed
- [ ] 2 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes, 1 red pepper — blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 handful spinach or ugu
- [ ] Salt

STEPS

1. Put yam in a pot with water to just cover. Boil 10 min.
2. Add the pepper blend, palm oil, crayfish and seasoning.
3. Cook 15 min until yam is very soft.
4. Mash some of the yam to thicken. Stir in greens.

Why it helps: Warm, soft and filling — easy for children who prefer smooth textures.

Kid tip: Mash it all smooth for children who don't like lumps.

LUNCH Chicken Fried Rice (no sweetcorn)

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups cooked rice (cold is best)
- [ ] 400 g chicken breast, diced
- [ ] 2 carrots, diced small
- [ ] 1 cup green beans + 1 cup peas
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp curry powder, 1 tsp thyme
- [ ] 2 tbsp coconut aminos, 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] Spring onions, to finish

STEPS

1. Cook chicken in 1 tbsp oil with curry and thyme, 8 min. Set aside.
2. Add remaining oil, onion, garlic and vegetables. Cook 5 min.
3. Add the rice and stir-fry 5 min.
4. Return chicken, add coconut aminos and toss.
5. Finish with spring onions.

Why it helps: All the party flavour with no stock cubes, soy sauce or sweetcorn.

Allergy note: Nigerian fried rice usually has sweetcorn — we leave it out (corn).

DINNER Mild Coconut Chicken & Spinach Curry

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g chicken thighs, diced
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure curry powder, ½ tsp turmeric
- [ ] 2 tomatoes, chopped
- [ ] 2 handfuls spinach
- [ ] Rice, to serve

STEPS

1. Soften onion, garlic and ginger in oil, 3 min.
2. Add curry and turmeric, stir 1 min.
3. Add chicken and tomatoes, cook 5 min.
4. Pour in coconut milk and simmer 15 min.
5. Stir in spinach. Serve with rice.

Why it helps: Turmeric and ginger are warming and gentle on the tummy.

WEEK 2

Day 10

"Progress, not perfection."

BREAKFAST Avocado & Tomato Buckwheat Toast

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 slices Easy Buckwheat Bread (see Basics)
- [ ] 2 ripe avocados
- [ ] 2 tomatoes, sliced
- [ ] Squeeze of lemon, pinch of salt
- [ ] 1 tbsp pumpkin seeds

STEPS

1. Toast the bread.
2. Mash avocado with lemon and salt.
3. Spread on toast and top with tomato and pumpkin seeds.

Why it helps: Healthy fats keep children full and focused through the morning.

LUNCH Ghana Red Red with Baked Dodo

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups black-eyed beans, soaked
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 3 tomatoes, 1 scotch bonnet — blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 3 ripe plantains
- [ ] 1 tbsp coconut oil

STEPS

1. Boil beans until soft, 40 min. Drain.
2. Warm palm oil, add the blend and cook 10 min.
3. Add beans, crayfish and seasoning. Simmer 10 min.
4. Slice plantain, toss in coconut oil and bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min.
5. Serve together.

Why it helps: Beans are rich in fibre and plant protein. Baking the dodo keeps it light.

DINNER Turkey Burgers & Sweet Potato Fries

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g turkey mince
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] 1 small carrot, finely grated
- [ ] 2 tbsp cassava flour
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic powder, ½ tsp paprika, salt
- [ ] 3 sweet potatoes, cut into fries
- [ ] Lettuce, tomato, avocado

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F. Toss fries in oil and salt and bake 30 min.
2. Mix turkey, flax egg, carrot, flour and spices. Shape 6 patties.
3. Bake the burgers on parchment 18–20 min, turning once.
4. Serve in lettuce cups or on buckwheat toast with tomato and avocado.

Why it helps: Burger night without wheat buns, cheese or processed sauce.

Picky eater trick: Let children build their own burger. Kids eat what they build.

WEEK 2

Day 11

Today's habit: 10 minutes outside in the morning sun.

BREAKFAST Coconut Quinoa Porridge with Mango

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup quinoa, rinsed well
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 1 cup water
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup (optional)
- [ ] 1 mango, diced

STEPS

1. Simmer quinoa, coconut milk, water and cinnamon for 15 min, stirring now and then.
2. Sweeten with maple if needed.
3. Top with mango.

Why it helps: Quinoa is a gluten-free seed with complete protein.

LUNCH Hidden-Veg Tomato Soup & Toast Soldiers

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 8 tomatoes (or 2 tins)
- [ ] 1 red pepper, 1 carrot, 1 small sweet potato
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 3 cups stock or water + 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] ½ cup coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tsp dried basil
- [ ] Buckwheat toast, cut into strips

STEPS

1. Soften onion and garlic in olive oil, 3 min.
2. Add all the vegetables, stock and basil. Simmer 20 min.
3. Blend until completely smooth.
4. Stir in coconut milk.
5. Serve with toast soldiers for dipping.

Why it helps: Five vegetables — and your child won't see a single one.

Kid tip: Smooth soups are a great "safe" food for children who dislike textures.

DINNER Ofada Rice & Mild Green Pepper Stew

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups ofada rice (or brown rice), washed
- [ ] 6 green peppers, 2 green scotch bonnets (fewer for kids)
- [ ] 2 onions
- [ ] 500 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 4 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 2 tsp iru (optional)
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt

STEPS

1. Boil the rice until tender, 35 min.
2. Cook beef with onion and seasoning until tender. Keep stock.
3. Blend peppers and onion roughly.
4. Warm palm oil gently, add pepper blend and cook 15 min.
5. Add beef, crayfish, iru and a little stock. Simmer 10 min.

Why it helps: Ofada is a whole-grain local rice with more fibre than white rice.

WEEK 2

Day 12

"You are building healthy habits that will last a lifetime."

BREAKFAST Green Smoothie Bowl

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 frozen bananas
- [ ] 1 cup frozen mango
- [ ] 1 handful spinach
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] Toppings: Crunchy Nut-Free Granola, berries, coconut

STEPS

1. Blend banana, mango, spinach and coconut milk until thick.
2. Pour into bowls.
3. Let children add their own toppings.

Why it helps: Mango and banana hide the spinach — it just tastes like ice cream.

Picky eater trick: Call it "Hulk ice cream" or "dinosaur smoothie". Fun names work!

LUNCH Chicken Shawarma Rice Bowl

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g chicken thighs
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin, paprika, turmeric; ½ tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, juice of 1 lemon
- [ ] 2 cups rice
- [ ] Cucumber, tomato, cabbage — chopped
- [ ] Garlic sauce: ½ cup coconut yogurt, 1 garlic clove, lemon, salt

STEPS

1. Mix spices, garlic, lemon and oil. Coat chicken and rest 20 min.
2. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 25 min, then slice.
3. Cook the rice.
4. Stir the garlic sauce together.
5. Build bowls: rice, chicken, salad, sauce.

Why it helps: Shawarma without the wheat wrap or mayonnaise — just as tasty.

DINNER Vegetable Soup with Fish & Boiled Yam

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 bunches ugu, finely chopped
- [ ] 2 bunches waterleaf or extra spinach
- [ ] 500 g tilapia or mackerel
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Boiled yam, to serve

STEPS

1. Season fish with onion and seasoning. Cook gently in 1 cup water, 10 min.
2. Add palm oil, pepper and crayfish. Cook 5 min.
3. Add waterleaf and cook 5 min.
4. Add ugu, stir and cook 3 min.
5. Serve with boiled yam.

Why it helps: Packed with iron, folate and magnesium from the greens.

WEEK 2

Day 13

It's Friday — Sweet Treat Day! See this week's sweet treats.

BREAKFAST Fluffy Sweet Potato Pancakes

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup mashed sweet potato
- [ ] 1 cup buckwheat flour
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] ¾ cup coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon, pinch of salt
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda + 1 tsp lemon juice
- [ ] Coconut oil, for the pan

STEPS

1. Mix sweet potato, flax egg and milk.
2. Stir in flour, cinnamon, salt and soda, then the lemon.
3. Cook small pancakes in a lightly oiled pan, 2–3 min each side.
4. Serve with coconut yogurt and berries.

Why it helps: Naturally sweet from the sweet potato — no sugar needed.

LUNCH Ghana Light Soup with Chicken & Rice Balls

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 kg chicken pieces
- [ ] 4 tomatoes, 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 2 garden eggs (optional)
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 6 cups water
- [ ] Rice balls (omo tuo): 2 cups soft-cooked rice

STEPS

1. Season chicken with onion, ginger and seasoning. Steam 10 min without water.
2. Add water, whole tomatoes, pepper and garden eggs. Boil 15 min.
3. Lift out the vegetables, blend smooth and return to the pot.
4. Simmer 20 min.
5. Mash the soft rice and shape into balls. Serve in the soup.

Why it helps: A light, clear, soothing soup — perfect when tummies are sensitive.

DINNER Beef Kebab Skewers with Rice & Salad

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g beef steak, cubed
- [ ] 1 red pepper, 1 onion — chunks
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil, juice of 1 lemon
- [ ] 1 tsp each paprika, garlic powder, thyme; salt
- [ ] Rice, to serve
- [ ] Cucumber & tomato salad

STEPS

1. Mix oil, lemon and spices. Coat beef and rest 20 min.
2. Thread beef and vegetables onto soaked skewers.
3. Bake at 220 °C / 425 °F for 15 min, turning once.
4. Serve with rice and salad.

Why it helps: Food on a stick is fun — children happily eat what's on a skewer.

WEEK 2

Day 14

Sunday: batch-cook day — bake bread, make granola, soak beans for the week.

BREAKFAST Fonio (Acha) Porridge with Coconut & Banana

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup fonio (acha), rinsed
- [ ] 2 cups water + 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] ½ tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 2 ripe bananas, sliced
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey or maple (optional)

STEPS

1. Bring water and coconut milk to the boil.
2. Stir in fonio and cinnamon. Cook 5–7 min on low.
3. Top with banana and a drizzle of honey.

Why it helps: Fonio is an ancient West African grain — gluten-free and quick to cook.

LUNCH Shepherd's Pie with Sweet Potato Mash

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g beef or lamb mince
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 carrots, 1 courgette — finely diced
- [ ] 1 tin chopped tomatoes
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 tbsp tapioca flour
- [ ] 1 kg sweet potatoes
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil

STEPS

1. Brown mince with onion. Add vegetables, tomatoes, thyme and seasoning. Simmer 20 min.
2. Stir in tapioca mixed with a little water to thicken.
3. Boil and mash sweet potatoes with olive oil and salt.
4. Spread mince in a dish and top with mash.
5. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min.

Why it helps: Comfort food with hidden vegetables in every spoonful.

DINNER Beef, Pumpkin & Potato Soup (inspired by Mama's soup)

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 2 cups pumpkin or butternut, cubed
- [ ] 3 Irish potatoes, cubed
- [ ] 2 carrots
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 6 cups water

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion, garlic, thyme and seasoning for 30 min until tender. Lift out and shred.
2. Add pumpkin, potato and carrot to the stock. Cook 15 min.
3. Blend smooth — or blend half and chop the rest tiny.
4. Return beef and simmer 5 min.
5. Serve with buckwheat bread.

Why it helps: Pumpkin and potato are root-vegetable carbs from the author's “foods to eat” list.

Kid tip: Same idea as Mama's Chicken, Potato & Carrot Soup — a new flavour for the same safe texture.

SWEET TREAT

Banana Bread Bites

No processed sugar
35 min · makes 16

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 very ripe bananas, mashed
- [ ] 1½ cups buckwheat flour
- [ ] 2 flax eggs
- [ ] ¼ cup melted coconut oil
- [ ] 2 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon, 1 tsp baking soda
- [ ] 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a square tin with parchment.
2. Mix banana, flax eggs, oil and maple.
3. Stir in flour, cinnamon and soda, then the vinegar.
4. Bake 25 min. Cool and cut into squares.

Why it helps: Sweetened almost entirely by banana. Perfect for lunch boxes too.

SWEET TREAT

Carob Fudge Bites

No processed sugar
15 min + chilling

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup soft pitted dates
- [ ] 3 tbsp carob powder
- [ ] 3 tbsp sunflower-seed butter
- [ ] 2 tbsp coconut oil
- [ ] Desiccated coconut, for rolling

STEPS

1. Blend dates, carob, seed butter and oil until sticky.
2. Roll into small balls.
3. Roll in coconut and chill 1 hour.

Why it helps: Tastes like chocolate fudge — no cocoa, no caffeine, no nuts.

Every Friday is Sweet Treat Day — because healing food should still feel like a celebration.

WEEK 3 · TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 3 shopping list

Everything for Days 15–21. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Spinach / ugu — 4 bunches
- [ ] Sukuma (collards) or kale — 2 bunches
- [ ] Broccoli — 1 head
- [ ] Tomatoes — 18
- [ ] Red peppers — 6, green pepper — 2
- [ ] Scotch bonnet — 4
- [ ] Onions — 12
- [ ] Garlic — 2 bulbs, ginger — 1 piece
- [ ] Carrots — 10
- [ ] Celery — 2 sticks
- [ ] Courgette — 1
- [ ] Green beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Garden eggs — 6
- [ ] Mushrooms — 200 g
- [ ] Sweet potatoes — 2
- [ ] Baby potatoes — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Potatoes — 1 kg
- [ ] Avocado — 1
- [ ] Frozen peas — 2 cups

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Ripe or half-ripe plantains — 3
- [ ] Green bananas (matoke) — 8 or green plantains — 4
- [ ] Mangoes — 2
- [ ] Bananas — 2
- [ ] Apple — 1
- [ ] Berries — 1 punnet
- [ ] Lemons — 3

Protein

- [ ] Beef cubes — 1.3 kg
- [ ] Beef steak — 400 g
- [ ] Beef mince — 500 g
- [ ] Chicken breast — 1 kg
- [ ] Chicken pieces — 500 g
- [ ] Turkey mince — 400 g
- [ ] Salmon fillets — 4
- [ ] White fish fillets — 500 g
- [ ] Tilapia or mackerel — 8
- [ ] Smoked mackerel — 1
- [ ] Black-eyed beans — 3 cups
- [ ] Butter/haricot beans — 2 tins
- [ ] Plain beans (no sugar) — 1 tin

Grains & flours

- [ ] Buckwheat flour, buckwheat groats
- [ ] Ground ogbono — ½ cup
- [ ] Pure millet flour — 3 cups
- [ ] Red lentils — 1 cup
- [ ] Long-grain rice — 6 cups
- [ ] Rice pasta — 800 g
- [ ] Rice noodles — 200 g
- [ ] Certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] Cassava flour
- [ ] Amala (yam flour)

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 7 tins
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 1 tub
- [ ] Passata — 1 jar
- [ ] Chopped tomatoes — 1 tin
- [ ] Red palm oil, olive & avocado oil
- [ ] Coconut aminos, carob powder
- [ ] Chia seeds, ground flaxseed
- [ ] Pure maple syrup, dates
- [ ] Tapioca flour
- [ ] Waakye leaves (optional)

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Fresh parsley or dill, mint
- [ ] Fresh coriander
- [ ] Oregano, thyme, sage
- [ ] Curry powder, cumin, turmeric, paprika
- [ ] Ground ginger, cayenne
- [ ] Cinnamon, garlic & onion powder

WEEK 3

Day 15

Week 3 — halfway there. Be proud of every small step.

BREAKFAST Buckwheat Crêpes with Berries

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup buckwheat flour
- [ ] 1¼ cups coconut milk or water
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] Pinch of salt
- [ ] 1 tbsp coconut oil
- [ ] Berries & coconut yogurt, to serve

STEPS

1. Whisk flour, milk, flax egg and salt to a thin batter. Rest 10 min.
2. Heat a little oil in a non-stick pan.
3. Pour a thin layer, swirl, cook 1–2 min, flip, 1 min.
4. Fill with berries and coconut yogurt and roll up.

Why it helps: Thin, soft crêpes are easy for little hands — and full of magnesium.

LUNCH Ogbono Soup with Beef & Amala

45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ cup ground ogbono
- [ ] 500 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 scotch bonnet, 1 onion
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 cup ugu or spinach
- [ ] Amala (yam flour), to serve

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning until tender. Keep 3 cups stock.
2. Warm palm oil on low, stir in ogbono for 1 min only.
3. Whisk in the stock little by little.
4. Add beef, pepper and crayfish. Simmer 10 min.
5. Add greens and serve with amala.

Why it helps: Ogbono's soft, smooth texture is gentle on the gut.

DINNER Creamy Chicken & Spinach Pasta

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g rice or gluten-free pasta
- [ ] 400 g chicken breast, sliced
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, 1 onion
- [ ] 2 handfuls spinach
- [ ] 2 tbsp nutritional yeast (optional), salt, pepper

STEPS

1. Cook the pasta as the pack says.
2. Cook chicken with onion and garlic in olive oil, 8 min.
3. Pour in coconut milk and nutritional yeast. Simmer 5 min.
4. Stir in spinach until wilted.
5. Toss with the pasta.

Why it helps: A creamy, cheesy-tasting pasta with no dairy at all.

WEEK 3

Day 16

Today's habit: bounce, dance or jump for 10 minutes.

BREAKFAST Boiled Plantain & Garden Egg Sauce

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 ripe or half-ripe plantains
- [ ] 6 garden eggs
- [ ] 2 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes, ½ scotch bonnet
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish
- [ ] 1 small smoked mackerel, flaked (optional)
- [ ] Salt

STEPS

1. Boil plantains in their skins 15 min.
2. Boil garden eggs 10 min, peel and mash.
3. Warm palm oil, add onion, tomato and pepper. Cook 5 min.
4. Add garden egg, crayfish and fish. Cook 5 min.
5. Serve with the plantain.

Why it helps: Garden eggs are high in fibre and gentle on digestion.

LUNCH Lentil & Sweet Potato Soup

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup red lentils, rinsed
- [ ] 2 sweet potatoes, cubed
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 carrots, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp cumin, ½ tsp turmeric
- [ ] 5 cups stock or water + 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Juice of ½ lemon
- [ ] Buckwheat bread, to serve

STEPS

1. Soften onion, carrot and garlic in oil, 5 min.
2. Add spices, lentils, sweet potato and stock.
3. Simmer 20 min until soft.
4. Blend smooth and add lemon.

Why it helps: Lentils give protein, iron and fibre — great support for steady energy.

DINNER Nut-Free Chicken Suya & Yam Fries

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g chicken breast, cut into strips
- [ ] 2 tsp paprika, 1 tsp ground ginger
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic & onion powder, salt
- [ ] ¼ tsp cayenne (or none for kids)
- [ ] ½ medium yam, cut into fries
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] Sliced onion, tomato, cucumber

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F.
2. Toss yam fries in oil and salt and bake 25–30 min.
3. Rub chicken with spices and oil. Thread onto skewers.
4. Bake 12–15 min, turning once.
5. Serve with fresh onion, tomato and cucumber.

Why it helps: Classic suya spice uses groundnut — this version is nut-free and just as tasty.

WEEK 3

Day 17

"Every meal you cook is an act of love."

BREAKFAST Mango Chia Pudding

5 min + overnight

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ cup chia seeds
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] 1 mango, blended
- [ ] Diced mango, to top

STEPS

1. Stir chia, coconut milk and maple. Rest 10 min and stir again.
2. Chill overnight.
3. Layer with mango purée and top with diced mango.

Why it helps: Chia seeds are the author's top tip for constipation — gentle soluble fibre.

LUNCH Coconut Rice with Pepper Fish

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups long-grain rice
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 2 cups water
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 red peppers, 1 scotch bonnet — blended
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp curry, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 4 tilapia or mackerel
- [ ] Fresh coriander, lemon

STEPS

1. Cook the pepper blend in olive oil 5 min.
2. Add rice, coconut milk, water and spices.
3. Cover and cook on low 25 min.
4. Rub fish with coriander, lemon and salt. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min.
5. Serve together.

Why it helps: Coconut milk adds richness without any dairy.

DINNER Mini Meatballs in Tomato Sauce

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g beef mince
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] 2 tbsp cassava flour
- [ ] ½ courgette, finely grated
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic powder, 1 tsp oregano, salt
- [ ] 1 jar passata (700 g)
- [ ] 400 g rice pasta

STEPS

1. Mix mince, flax egg, flour, courgette and seasoning. Roll 24 small balls.
2. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 15 min.
3. Warm passata with oregano. Add meatballs and simmer 10 min.
4. Cook the pasta and serve with meatballs and sauce.

Why it helps: Hidden courgette in every meatball. Cook extra for lunch boxes.

WEEK 3

Day 18

Today's habit: lemon balm tea 2 hours before bed.

BREAKFAST Baked Akara Bites & Millet Porridge

40 min + soaking

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups black-eyed beans, soaked & peeled
- [ ] 1 small onion, ½ scotch bonnet, salt
- [ ] Olive oil, for the tin
- [ ] 1 cup pure millet flour
- [ ] 4 cups water, 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 3 dates, chopped

STEPS

1. Blend beans, onion, pepper and salt with very little water. Whisk 3 min until fluffy.
2. Spoon into an oiled mini muffin tin. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20–25 min.
3. Whisk millet flour with 1 cup cold water.
4. Boil remaining water with dates, stir in the millet and cook 8 min. Add coconut milk.

Why it helps: A classic Nigerian breakfast — gluten-free, egg-free, corn-free and baked.

LUNCH Beef & Veg Stir-Fry with Rice Noodles

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g beef steak, thinly sliced
- [ ] 1 head broccoli, 2 carrots, 1 red pepper
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 3 tbsp coconut aminos
- [ ] 1 tsp tapioca flour + 2 tbsp water
- [ ] 200 g rice noodles
- [ ] 2 tbsp avocado oil

STEPS

1. Soak or cook noodles as the pack says.
2. Stir-fry beef in hot oil 3 min. Set aside.
3. Stir-fry vegetables, garlic and ginger 4 min.
4. Return beef, add coconut aminos and tapioca mix.
5. Toss with noodles until glossy.

Why it helps: Quick, colourful and soy-free — coconut aminos replaces soy sauce.

DINNER Sukuma Wiki, Beef & Millet Ugali

45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 bunches sukuma (collard greens) or kale, sliced
- [ ] 400 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 2 cups pure millet (wimbi) or sorghum flour
- [ ] 4 cups water

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning until tender.
2. Add tomatoes and cook 5 min. Add greens, cook 5 min.
3. For ugali: boil water, add flour slowly, stirring hard.
4. Keep stirring 5–8 min until thick and pulling from the pot.
5. Shape and serve with the greens.

Why it helps: Ugali is usually made with maize. Millet keeps the Kenyan classic corn-free.

Swap it: Kale or spinach works perfectly outside Kenya.

WEEK 3

Day 19

"Your child is not giving you a hard time. They are having a hard time."

BREAKFAST Banana-Carob Overnight Oats

5 min + overnight

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 2 ripe bananas, mashed
- [ ] 1 tbsp carob powder
- [ ] 1 tbsp chia seeds

STEPS

1. Stir everything together.
2. Divide into jars and chill overnight.
3. Top with sliced banana.

Why it helps: Carob tastes like chocolate — with no caffeine.

LUNCH Chakalaka Bean Stew with Rice

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 tins butter beans or haricot beans, drained
- [ ] 1 onion, 1 red & 1 green pepper, diced
- [ ] 2 carrots, grated
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 1 tsp pure curry powder
- [ ] 3 tomatoes, chopped
- [ ] Rice, to serve

STEPS

1. Soften onion, peppers and garlic in oil, 5 min.
2. Add ginger, curry and carrot. Cook 3 min.
3. Add tomatoes and simmer 10 min.
4. Stir in beans and heat through.
5. Serve with rice.

Why it helps: A South African favourite — colourful, mild and full of fibre.

Allergy note: Most tinned baked beans have added sugar. Use plain beans.

DINNER Baked Salmon, Potatoes & Green Beans

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 salmon fillets
- [ ] 1 kg baby potatoes, halved
- [ ] 2 cups green beans
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 lemon, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] Fresh parsley or dill, salt

STEPS

1. Toss potatoes with oil and salt. Roast at 200 °C / 400 °F for 25 min.
2. Add salmon and green beans to the tray. Top with lemon, garlic and herbs.
3. Roast 12–15 min more.
4. Serve straight from the tray.

Why it helps: Salmon is low in mercury and rich in omega-3 for the brain.

WEEK 3

Day 20

It's Friday — Sweet Treat Day!

BREAKFAST Apple Cinnamon Buckwheat Porridge

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup buckwheat groats, soaked overnight & rinsed
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 1 apple, grated
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup

STEPS

1. Simmer buckwheat and coconut milk 10 min.
2. Stir in apple and cinnamon. Cook 5 min.
3. Sweeten with maple and serve warm.

Why it helps: Apple adds natural sweetness and fibre.

LUNCH Waakye with Fish Stew

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups rice
- [ ] 1 cup black-eyed beans, soaked
- [ ] A few dried sorghum (waakye) leaves, or ¼ tsp baking soda
- [ ] 4 mackerel or tilapia
- [ ] 6 tomatoes, 2 red peppers, 1 onion — blended
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Salt

STEPS

1. Boil beans with waakye leaves 30 min.
2. Add rice and more water. Cook until tender, 20 min. Remove leaves.
3. Cook the tomato blend in oil 15 min until thick.
4. Add fish and seasoning. Simmer 10 min.
5. Serve waakye with the fish stew.

Why it helps: Rice and beans together make a complete protein.

DINNER Friday Fish & Chips with Mushy Peas

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g white fish fillets
- [ ] 1 cup cassava flour, 1 tsp paprika, salt
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 kg potatoes, cut into chips
- [ ] 2 cups frozen peas
- [ ] Fresh mint, lemon

STEPS

1. Toss chips in 2 tbsp oil and salt. Bake at 220 °C / 425 °F for 35 min.
2. Brush fish with oil, coat in seasoned flour.
3. Bake fish 12–15 min until golden.
4. Boil peas 3 min and mash with mint, olive oil and salt.
5. Serve with lemon.

Why it helps: A British classic, baked not fried — no wheat batter.

WEEK 3

Day 21

Sunday: batch-cook day — make seasoning mix and freeze soup portions.

BREAKFAST Sunday Breakfast Plate

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g turkey mince
- [ ] 1 tsp dried sage or thyme, ½ tsp garlic powder, salt
- [ ] 500 g baby potatoes, halved
- [ ] 200 g mushrooms
- [ ] 2 tomatoes, halved
- [ ] 1 avocado
- [ ] 1 tin plain beans (no added sugar)

STEPS

1. Roast potatoes at 200 °C / 400 °F for 25 min.
2. Mix turkey with herbs and salt. Shape 8 small patties.
3. Pan-cook patties 4 min each side.
4. Cook mushrooms and tomatoes in the same pan.
5. Serve with warm beans and avocado.

Why it helps: A full breakfast with no pork sausages, bacon or eggs.

LUNCH Matoke (Green Banana & Beef Stew)

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 8 green cooking bananas (matoke) or 4 green plantains
- [ ] 400 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 1 onion, 3 tomatoes
- [ ] 1 carrot, 1 green pepper
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] Fresh coriander

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and garlic until tender.
2. Add tomatoes, carrot and pepper. Cook 5 min.
3. Peel bananas (oil your hands) and add with water to cover.
4. Simmer 20 min until soft.
5. Mash a little to thicken. Finish with coriander.

Why it helps: Green banana feeds good gut bacteria — on the author's healing-the-gut list.

DINNER Chicken & Rice Soup

45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken pieces
- [ ] ½ cup rice
- [ ] 2 carrots, 2 celery sticks
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 6 cups water
- [ ] Fresh parsley

STEPS

1. Simmer chicken with onion, garlic, thyme and seasoning for 25 min. Lift out and shred.
2. Add rice, carrot and celery. Cook 15 min.
3. Blend the vegetables first if your child prefers it smooth.
4. Return chicken and finish with parsley.

Why it helps: Simple, soothing chicken soup — the best food when someone is unwell.

SWEET TREAT

Baked Cinnamon Apples with Coconut Cream

No processed sugar
35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 apples, cored
- [ ] 2 tbsp raisins or chopped dates
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp coconut oil
- [ ] Whipped coconut cream

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F.
2. Fill apples with dates, cinnamon and a little coconut oil.
3. Bake 25–30 min until soft.
4. Serve warm with coconut cream.

Why it helps: Warm, soft and comforting — like apple pie without the pastry.

SWEET TREAT

Mango Coconut Rice Pudding

No processed sugar
35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ cup short-grain rice
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 1 cup water
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] ½ tsp vanilla powder
- [ ] 1 mango, diced

STEPS

1. Simmer rice in water 15 min.
2. Add coconut milk, maple and vanilla. Cook 15 min, stirring.
3. Serve warm or chilled, topped with mango.

Why it helps: Creamy, dairy-free and naturally sweet.

Every Friday is **Sweet Treat Day** — because healing food should still feel like a celebration.

WEEK 4 · TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 4 shopping list

Everything for Days 22–28. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Spinach / ugu — 4 bunches
- [ ] Romaine or gem lettuce — 2
- [ ] Cabbage — 1
- [ ] Tomatoes — 22
- [ ] Red peppers — 7, other peppers — 6
- [ ] Scotch bonnet — 6
- [ ] Onions — 14
- [ ] Garlic — 2 bulbs, ginger — 1 piece
- [ ] Carrots — 8
- [ ] Green beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Broccoli — 1 head
- [ ] Mushrooms — 100 g
- [ ] Potatoes — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Parsnips or sweet potatoes — 2
- [ ] Avocados — 3

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Yam — 1 medium
- [ ] Ripe plantains — 2
- [ ] Green plantains — 4
- [ ] Bananas — 2
- [ ] Mangoes — 2
- [ ] Pineapple — 1
- [ ] Pawpaw — 1 small
- [ ] Passion fruit — 2 (optional)
- [ ] Lemons — 3, limes — 2

Protein

- [ ] Beef cubes — 600 g
- [ ] Chicken breast — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Chicken drumsticks — 8
- [ ] Chicken (whole or pieces) — 1 kg
- [ ] Turkey mince — 700 g
- [ ] Turkey thighs — 1 kg
- [ ] Fresh fish (tilapia/catfish) — 1.1 kg
- [ ] White fish — 500 g
- [ ] Smoked mackerel — 1
- [ ] Sardines in olive oil — 1 tin
- [ ] Honey beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Kidney beans — 2 tins
- [ ] Black beans — 1 tin

Grains & flours

- [ ] Rice spaghetti — 400 g
- [ ] Long-grain rice — 8 cups
- [ ] Pure millet flour — 1 cup
- [ ] Tiger nuts — 1 cup
- [ ] Cassava flour (for flatbreads)
- [ ] Pounded yam flour

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 4 tins
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 2 tubs
- [ ] Dairy-free cheese — 1 pack
- [ ] Palm nut concentrate — 1 tin
- [ ] Passata — 1 jar, tomato paste
- [ ] Red palm, olive & avocado oil
- [ ] Coconut aminos, raw honey
- [ ] Mustard (check label)
- [ ] Nutritional yeast
- [ ] Ground flaxseed, tapioca flour

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Scent leaves or basil
- [ ] Utazi or uziza (or basil)
- [ ] Ogiri (optional), crayfish
- [ ] Pepper soup spice (pure)
- [ ] Rosemary, thyme, oregano, bay
- [ ] Cumin, paprika, curry, garlic powder

WEEK 4

Day 22

Week 4 — look how far you've come. Keep going, Mama and Papa.

BREAKFAST Beans & Ripe Plantain Porridge

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups honey beans (oloyin), soaked
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes, 1 pepper — blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 2 ripe plantains, cubed
- [ ] Salt

STEPS

1. Boil beans until very soft, 45 min.
2. Add the blend, palm oil, crayfish and seasoning.
3. Add plantain and cook 10 min.
4. Mash a little until creamy.

Why it helps: Honey beans are naturally sweet — children love them.

LUNCH Chicken Caesar-Style Lettuce Wraps

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken breast
- [ ] 1 head romaine or gem lettuce
- [ ] Dressing: ½ cup coconut yogurt, 1 garlic clove
- [ ] Juice of ½ lemon, 1 tsp mustard (check label)
- [ ] 2 tbsp nutritional yeast, salt
- [ ] Buckwheat bread, cubed & toasted

STEPS

1. Season and bake chicken at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min. Slice.
2. Whisk the dressing together.
3. Toast bread cubes in a little olive oil for croutons.
4. Fill lettuce leaves with chicken, croutons and dressing.

Why it helps: Caesar dressing usually has egg and cheese. This one has neither.

DINNER Banga Soup with Fish & Rice

45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 tin palm nut concentrate (400 g)
- [ ] 500 g fresh fish (tilapia or catfish)
- [ ] 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Handful scent leaves or basil
- [ ] 3 cups water
- [ ] Rice, to serve

STEPS

1. Bring palm nut concentrate and water to the boil. Simmer 15 min.
2. Add onion, pepper, crayfish and seasoning.
3. Add fish gently and cook 10 min.
4. Stir in scent leaves.
5. Serve with rice.

Why it helps: A Delta favourite — rich in vitamin E from the palm fruit.

WEEK 4

Day 23

Today's habit: add a spoon of seeds to one meal.

BREAKFAST Tropical Granola Bowl

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups coconut yogurt
- [ ] 1 cup Crunchy Nut-Free Granola
- [ ] 1 mango, 1 cup pineapple — diced
- [ ] 2 passion fruit (optional)

STEPS

1. Spoon yogurt into bowls.
2. Top with fruit and granola.
3. Add passion fruit seeds.

Why it helps: Coconut yogurt and fruit feed good gut bacteria.

LUNCH Jollof Spaghetti

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g rice spaghetti
- [ ] 500 g chicken, diced
- [ ] 5 tomatoes, 2 red peppers, 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet — blended
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato paste, 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp curry, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 cup mixed carrots & green beans, diced

STEPS

1. Cook chicken with seasoning until done.
2. Fry tomato paste in oil 3 min. Add blend and cook 15 min.
3. Add spices, vegetables and chicken.
4. Cook spaghetti until just soft and toss through the sauce.

Why it helps: Jollof flavour + pasta = a guaranteed hit with children.

DINNER Honey-Garlic Chicken, Rice & Broccoli

45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 8 chicken drumsticks
- [ ] 2 tbsp raw honey
- [ ] 3 tbsp coconut aminos
- [ ] 3 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger — grated
- [ ] 1 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] Rice and steamed broccoli

STEPS

1. Mix honey, coconut aminos, garlic, ginger and oil.
2. Coat drumsticks and rest 15 min.
3. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 40 min, basting halfway.
4. Serve with rice and broccoli.

Why it helps: Sticky, sweet and savoury — with real honey instead of sugar.

WEEK 4

Day 24

"Small steps every day add up to big changes."

BREAKFAST Millet Porridge with Tiger Nut Milk

15 min + soaking

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup tiger nuts, soaked overnight
- [ ] 3 cups water + 3 dates
- [ ] 1 cup pure millet flour
- [ ] 3 cups water, for porridge
- [ ] Pinch of ginger and cloves

STEPS

1. Blend tiger nuts, 3 cups water and dates. Strain through a cloth — this is your milk.
2. Whisk millet flour with 1 cup cold water.
3. Boil 2 cups water with ginger and cloves, stir in millet.
4. Cook 8 min, then stir in tiger nut milk.

Why it helps: Tiger nuts are tubers, not nuts — a creamy, naturally sweet dairy-free milk.

LUNCH Chicken Fajitas

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken breast, sliced
- [ ] 2 peppers, 1 onion — sliced
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin, paprika, garlic powder; salt
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil, juice of 1 lime
- [ ] 6 cassava flatbreads (see Basics)
- [ ] Avocado, tomato salsa, lettuce

STEPS

1. Toss chicken and vegetables with spices, oil and lime.
2. Cook in a hot pan 10 min until done.
3. Warm the flatbreads.
4. Fill with chicken, avocado, salsa and lettuce.

Why it helps: Most tortillas are made with corn or wheat. Cassava keeps fajita night safe.

DINNER Fish Pepper Soup with Yam

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g fish (catfish or tilapia), in steaks
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure pepper soup spice
- [ ] 1 onion, ½ scotch bonnet
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] Handful scent leaves or basil
- [ ] ½ yam, cubed
- [ ] 6 cups water

STEPS

1. Boil yam in the water 10 min.
2. Add onion, spice, pepper and seasoning.
3. Add fish gently and simmer 10 min.
4. Finish with scent leaves.

Why it helps: Warm pepper soup spices are traditionally used to soothe the tummy.

Kid tip: Use very little pepper for children — add extra to adult bowls.

WEEK 4

Day 25

Today's habit: screens off one hour before bed.

BREAKFAST Banana-Avocado Green Smoothie & Toast

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 ripe bananas
- [ ] ½ avocado
- [ ] 1 handful spinach
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground flaxseed
- [ ] Buckwheat toast

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Serve with buckwheat toast.

Why it helps: Avocado makes it creamy and filling. Flax adds omega-3.

LUNCH Nigerian Beef Stew, Rice & Steamed Veg

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 8 tomatoes, 3 red peppers, 2 onions, 1 scotch bonnet — blended
- [ ] 4 tbsp olive or palm oil
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp curry, 2 bay leaves
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] Rice
- [ ] Carrots & green beans, steamed

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning until tender. Keep the stock.
2. Cook the blend in a dry pot 10 min to reduce.
3. Add oil and spices. Cook 15 min until rich.
4. Add beef and a little stock. Simmer 10 min.
5. Serve with rice and steamed vegetables.

Why it helps: Classic Sunday stew — made without stock cubes or frying the meat.

DINNER Stuffed Peppers with Turkey & Rice

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 large peppers, tops cut off
- [ ] 400 g turkey mince
- [ ] 1 cup cooked rice
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes, chopped
- [ ] 1 tsp oregano, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] ½ cup dairy-free cheese (optional)

STEPS

1. Brown turkey and onion. Add tomatoes, oregano, seasoning. Cook 10 min.
2. Stir in the rice.
3. Fill the peppers. Top with cheese.
4. Bake covered with parchment at 190 °C / 375 °F for 30 min.

Why it helps: Colourful peppers are packed with vitamin C.

WEEK 4

Day 26

"Celebrate the bite, not the plate."

BREAKFAST Breakfast Burritos

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 6 cassava flatbreads (see Basics)
- [ ] 300 g turkey mince
- [ ] 2 potatoes, diced small
- [ ] 1 tin black beans, drained
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp cumin, salt
- [ ] 1 avocado, tomato salsa

STEPS

1. Roast potatoes with oil and salt at 220 °C / 425 °F for 20 min.
2. Cook turkey with spices 8 min.
3. Warm beans.
4. Fill flatbreads with everything and roll up.

Why it helps: A protein-packed breakfast that holds energy until lunch.

LUNCH Ofe Nsala (White Soup) with Chicken

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 kg chicken (or catfish)
- [ ] 4 small pieces yam (to thicken)
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 1 tsp ogiri (optional)
- [ ] Handful utazi or uziza leaves (or basil)
- [ ] Pounded yam

STEPS

1. Cook chicken with seasoning in 5 cups water, 25 min.
2. Boil yam separately, pound or blend until smooth.
3. Add pepper, crayfish and ogiri to the chicken.
4. Stir in small lumps of yam to thicken. Cook 10 min.
5. Add leaves and serve.

Why it helps: No palm oil — a light, peppery soup thickened naturally with yam.

DINNER Fish Tacos with Mango Salsa

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g white fish
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp cumin, salt
- [ ] 6 cassava flatbreads
- [ ] 2 cups shredded cabbage
- [ ] Salsa: 1 mango, ½ red onion, coriander, lime
- [ ] Coconut yogurt, to drizzle

STEPS

1. Season fish and bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 12 min. Flake.
2. Mix mango, onion, coriander and lime.
3. Warm the flatbreads.
4. Fill with cabbage, fish, salsa and yogurt.

Why it helps: Fresh, fruity and fun — children love the sweet mango.

WEEK 4

Day 27

It's Friday — Sweet Treat Day!

BREAKFAST Boiled Yam & Sardine-Tomato Sauce

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ yam, sliced
- [ ] 1 tin sardines in olive oil or water
- [ ] 3 tomatoes, 1 onion, ½ scotch bonnet
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] Handful spinach
- [ ] Salt

STEPS

1. Boil yam 15–20 min.
2. Cook onion, tomato and pepper in oil 8 min.
3. Add sardines, break up gently.
4. Stir in spinach. Serve with the yam.

Why it helps: Sardines are small, low-mercury fish packed with omega-3 and calcium.

Shopping tip: Choose sardines in olive oil or water — not in soybean oil or sauce.

LUNCH Kenyan Coconut Bean Stew (Maharagwe) & Rice

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 tins kidney beans, drained
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] ½ tsp turmeric, 1 tsp cumin, salt
- [ ] Fresh coriander
- [ ] Rice, to serve

STEPS

1. Soften onion and garlic in oil, 3 min.
2. Add tomatoes and spices. Cook 5 min.
3. Add beans and coconut milk. Simmer 15 min.
4. Finish with coriander. Serve with rice.

Why it helps: Creamy, mild and full of fibre — a Kenyan coastal classic.

DINNER Friday Pizza Night: Chicken & Veggie

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cassava flatbread pizza bases
- [ ] 1 cup passata, 1 tsp oregano
- [ ] 1 cup dairy-free cheese
- [ ] Cooked chicken, peppers, mushrooms, red onion
- [ ] Pineapple chunks (optional)
- [ ] Olive oil

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F.
2. Spread passata over the bases, sprinkle oregano.
3. Add cheese and toppings.
4. Bake 10–12 min until bubbling.

Why it helps: Pizza is back — make it a Friday family tradition.

Picky eater trick: Put toppings in little bowls and let each child design their own.

WEEK 4

Day 28

Sunday: batch-cook day — next week is the final stretch!

BREAKFAST Coconut Rice Porridge with Pawpaw

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup rice
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 2 cups water
- [ ] ½ tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey or maple (optional)
- [ ] 1 small pawpaw (papaya), diced

STEPS

1. Simmer rice in water 15 min.
2. Add coconut milk and cinnamon. Cook 10 min until creamy.
3. Top with pawpaw.

Why it helps: Pawpaw contains natural enzymes that help digestion.

LUNCH Sunday Roast Turkey Thighs & Gravy

1 hr 20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 kg turkey thighs
- [ ] 1 kg potatoes
- [ ] 4 carrots, 2 parsnips or sweet potatoes
- [ ] 1 garlic bulb, 1 lemon
- [ ] Fresh rosemary & thyme
- [ ] 3 tbsp avocado oil, salt
- [ ] 1 tbsp tapioca flour

STEPS

1. Rub turkey with oil, salt, herbs and lemon. Roast at 190 °C / 375 °F for 1 hr.
2. Parboil potatoes 8 min, toss in oil and roast with the vegetables 45 min.
3. Rest turkey 10 min.
4. Thicken pan juices with tapioca and water for gravy.

Why it helps: Turkey is lean, gentle protein — a lovely change from chicken.

DINNER Green Plantain Porridge

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 green (unripe) plantains, cubed
- [ ] 2 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion + 2 tomatoes + 1 pepper, blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 small smoked mackerel, flaked (not tuna)
- [ ] 1 cup ugu or spinach

STEPS

1. Warm the oil, add the blend and cook 5 min.
2. Add plantain, crayfish, seasoning and water to just cover.
3. Cook 20 min until soft. Mash a little to thicken.
4. Stir in the fish and greens. Cook 3 min.

Why it helps: Green plantain is full of resistant starch that feeds good gut bacteria.

SWEET TREAT

Sweet Potato Carob Brownies

No processed sugar
40 min · makes 16

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup mashed sweet potato
- [ ] ¾ cup buckwheat flour
- [ ] ⅓ cup carob powder
- [ ] 2 flax eggs
- [ ] ⅓ cup pure maple syrup
- [ ] ¼ cup melted coconut oil
- [ ] ½ tsp baking soda + 1 tsp lemon juice

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a square tin.
2. Mix sweet potato, flax eggs, maple and oil.
3. Stir in flour, carob and soda, then lemon.
4. Bake 25 min. Cool fully before cutting.

Why it helps: Fudgy brownies with a secret vegetable inside.

SWEET TREAT

Strawberry Coconut Cheesecake Cups

No processed sugar
20 min + chilling

YOU NEED

- [ ] Base: 1 cup dates + ½ cup sunflower seeds + ½ cup gluten-free oats
- [ ] 2 cups thick coconut yogurt
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] 1 cup strawberries, chopped
- [ ] Squeeze of lemon

STEPS

1. Blitz the base ingredients and press into 6 small cups.
2. Mix yogurt, maple and lemon. Spoon on top.
3. Top with strawberries. Chill 1 hour.

Why it helps: No-bake, no dairy, no nuts — a party-worthy treat.

Every Friday is Sweet Treat Day — because healing food should still feel like a celebration.

WEEK 5 · TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 5 shopping list

Everything for Days 29–30. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Cocoyam leaves or spinach — 4 bunches
- [ ] Tomatoes — 10
- [ ] Scotch bonnet — 2
- [ ] Onions — 6
- [ ] Garlic — 1 bulb
- [ ] Carrots — 4
- [ ] Celery — 2 sticks
- [ ] Cabbage — ½
- [ ] Lettuce — 1
- [ ] Avocados — 2

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Ripe plantains — 9
- [ ] Apples — 2
- [ ] Berries — 2 punnets
- [ ] Limes — 2, lemon — 1

Protein

- [ ] Chicken pieces — 1 kg
- [ ] Chicken breast — 500 g
- [ ] Beef mince — 500 g
- [ ] Smoked mackerel — 1
- [ ] Black beans — 1 tin

Grains & flours

- [ ] Short-grain rice — 1 cup
- [ ] Long-grain rice — 3 cups
- [ ] Rice noodles — 150 g
- [ ] Cassava flour

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 4 tins (2 chilled for cream)
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 1 tub
- [ ] Dairy-free cheese
- [ ] Tomato paste
- [ ] Ground egusi (optional)
- [ ] Ground flaxseed, baking soda
- [ ] Pure maple syrup
- [ ] Mustard (check label)

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Fresh parsley, coriander
- [ ] Thyme, oregano, curry, bay leaves
- [ ] Cumin, paprika, cinnamon
- [ ] Healing Seasoning Mix

WEEK 5

Day 29

The final stretch — two more days. You've got this.

BREAKFAST Cinnamon Apple Rice Pudding

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup short-grain rice
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 2 cups water
- [ ] 2 apples, grated
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup

STEPS

1. Simmer rice in water 15 min.
2. Add coconut milk, apple and cinnamon.
3. Cook 10 min until creamy.
4. Sweeten with maple.

Why it helps: A warm, cosy breakfast — perfect for children who love soft foods.

LUNCH Kontomire Stew with Boiled Plantain

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 bunches cocoyam leaves or spinach, chopped
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 3 tomatoes, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 2 tbsp ground egusi (optional)
- [ ] 1 smoked mackerel, flaked
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 4 plantains, boiled

STEPS

1. Cook onion, tomato and pepper in palm oil 10 min.
2. Mix egusi with water and add. Cook 5 min.
3. Add fish and seasoning.
4. Stir in greens and cook 5 min.
5. Serve with boiled plantain.

Why it helps: A Ghanaian favourite full of iron from the leafy greens.

DINNER Chicken Noodle Soup

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken breast
- [ ] 150 g rice noodles
- [ ] 2 carrots, 2 celery sticks
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 6 cups water
- [ ] Fresh parsley

STEPS

1. Simmer chicken with onion, garlic, thyme and seasoning 20 min. Shred.
2. Add carrot and celery. Cook 10 min.
3. Add noodles and cook 5 min.
4. Return chicken and finish with parsley.

Why it helps: Soft noodles and gentle broth — easy on sensitive tummies.

WEEK 5

Day 30

Day 30 — you did it! Celebrate together tonight.

BREAKFAST Celebration Plantain Pancake Stack

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 very ripe plantains
- [ ] ½ cup cassava flour
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] ½ cup coconut milk
- [ ] ½ tsp baking soda + squeeze of lemon
- [ ] Whipped coconut cream & berries

STEPS

1. Blend plantain, flour, flax egg, milk and soda; add lemon.
2. Cook small pancakes in a lightly oiled pan.
3. Stack high with coconut cream and berries between layers.

Why it helps: A celebration breakfast for 30 days of hard work.

LUNCH Party Jollof Plate

1 hr 15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] Jollof Rice with Baked Chicken (Day 3)
- [ ] 3 ripe plantains, sliced & baked
- [ ] Coleslaw: ½ cabbage, 2 carrots — shredded
- [ ] Dressing: ½ cup coconut yogurt, lemon, 1 tsp mustard, salt

STEPS

1. Make the jollof and chicken from Day 3.
2. Bake plantain slices at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min.
3. Mix cabbage, carrot and dressing.
4. Serve a big party plate for everyone.

Why it helps: Party coleslaw usually has egg mayonnaise. This dressing is egg-free.

DINNER Build-Your-Own Taco Bar

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g beef mince
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin, paprika, oregano, garlic powder; salt
- [ ] 8 cassava flatbreads
- [ ] 1 tin black beans
- [ ] Guacamole: 2 avocados, lime, salt
- [ ] Salsa, lettuce, dairy-free cheese

STEPS

1. Brown mince with spices. Add a splash of water and simmer 10 min.
2. Warm beans and flatbreads.
3. Make guacamole.
4. Put everything in bowls and let everyone build their own.

Why it helps: A fun, hands-on celebration dinner — every child chooses their own plate.

Picky eater trick: Children who help choose and build their food eat more of it.

PART 3

Extra help

Quick meals for hard days, where to shop, and a few words before you go.

FOR THE HARD DAYS

15-minute rescue meals

Some days are just hard. Meltdowns, no sleep, no energy. These meals take 15 minutes or less — and they're still safe and healing.

From the freezer

- Mama's chicken & potato soup + buckwheat toast
- Frozen meatballs + passata + rice pasta
- Banana oat muffins + a smoothie

From the cupboard

- Rice noodles + coconut milk + spinach + leftover chicken
- Sardines in tomato sauce + boiled yam
- Tinned beans + rice + avocado

No cooking at all

- Cassava wrap + leftover chicken + avocado
- Coconut yogurt + granola + fruit
- DIY “lunchable” plate: rice crackers, chicken, cucumber, grapes

Leftover makeovers

- Jollof rice → fried rice next day
- Butternut mac → baked mac bites
- Roast chicken → soup, wraps, fried rice
- Stew → pour over pasta or boiled yam

Be kind to yourself

A simple safe meal is a win. Cereal-for-dinner days happen to every parent — just make it a safe one.

MAKE SHOPPING EASIER

Allergy-friendly brands near you

Always read the label — brands can change their recipes. Many gluten-free products still contain corn or egg.

Nigeria

Swallows: Ola-Ola & Iyan Ado pounded yam flour, plantain flour

Rice: Ofada, Mama Gold, Royal Stallion

Dairy-free: Kara or Chaokoh coconut milk, homemade tigernut milk (kunu aya)

Oils: Figaro extra virgin olive oil, unrefined red palm oil

Shops: Spar, Prince Ebeano, Justrite, Grand Square, local markets

Ghana

Swallows: Pure cassava or plantain fufu flour (no corn), yam flour

Dairy-free: Coconut milk, homemade tigernut milk

Drinks: Sobolo (no sugar), ginger, coconut water

Shops: Melcom, MaxMart, Shoprite, Makola market

Kenya

Flours: Pure wimbi (finger millet) or sorghum flour — check no maize is added

Dairy-free: Kara coconut milk, coconut cream

Drinks: Ginger-lemongrass “chai” without tea leaves

Shops: Naivas, Quickmart, Carrefour, Chandarana

South Africa

Dairy-free: Oh Mylk, Alpro, Rhodes coconut milk

Drinks: Freshpak Rooibos (naturally caffeine-free)

Pantry: Nature's Choice, Bob's Red Mill gluten-free

Shops: Woolworths, Checkers, Dis-Chem, Faithful to Nature

United Kingdom

Dairy-free: Koko, Alpro, The Coconut Collaborative, Violife

African foods: Tropical Sun yam, plantain & cassava flours

Sauces: Free & Easy

Shops: Tesco & Sainsbury's Free From, Holland & Barrett, African shops

USA & Canada

Flours: Otto's Naturals cassava flour, Bob's Red Mill gluten-free

Dairy-free: So Delicious, Cocojune, Daiya, Earth's Own

Snacks: Enjoy Life, MadeGood

Shops: Whole Foods, Loblaws (PC Free From), Thrive Market

YOUR NOTES

My notes

Favourite recipes, changes that worked, foods your child tried...

YOU DID IT

Thirty days of love

Thirty days. Ninety meals. Hundreds of small, brave choices — by you *and* your child.

Whatever changed this month — a better night's sleep, a calmer afternoon, one new food tried, one less tummy ache — it matters. Write it down. Celebrate it.

What next?

- Start again at Day 1 — it gets easier every round.
- Mark your family's favourite days and repeat them.
- Keep using your food & mood tracker from the Printables pack.
- Bring foods back one at a time, and watch closely.

Your bonus books

- **Healing Lunch Box** — 30 days of school lunches.
- **Healing Sips** — 30 gentle detox drinks.
- **Healing Printables** — trackers, cards & charts.
- **Healing Celebrations** — birthday cake & parties.

You are doing an amazing job. Your child is lucky to have you.

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

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